

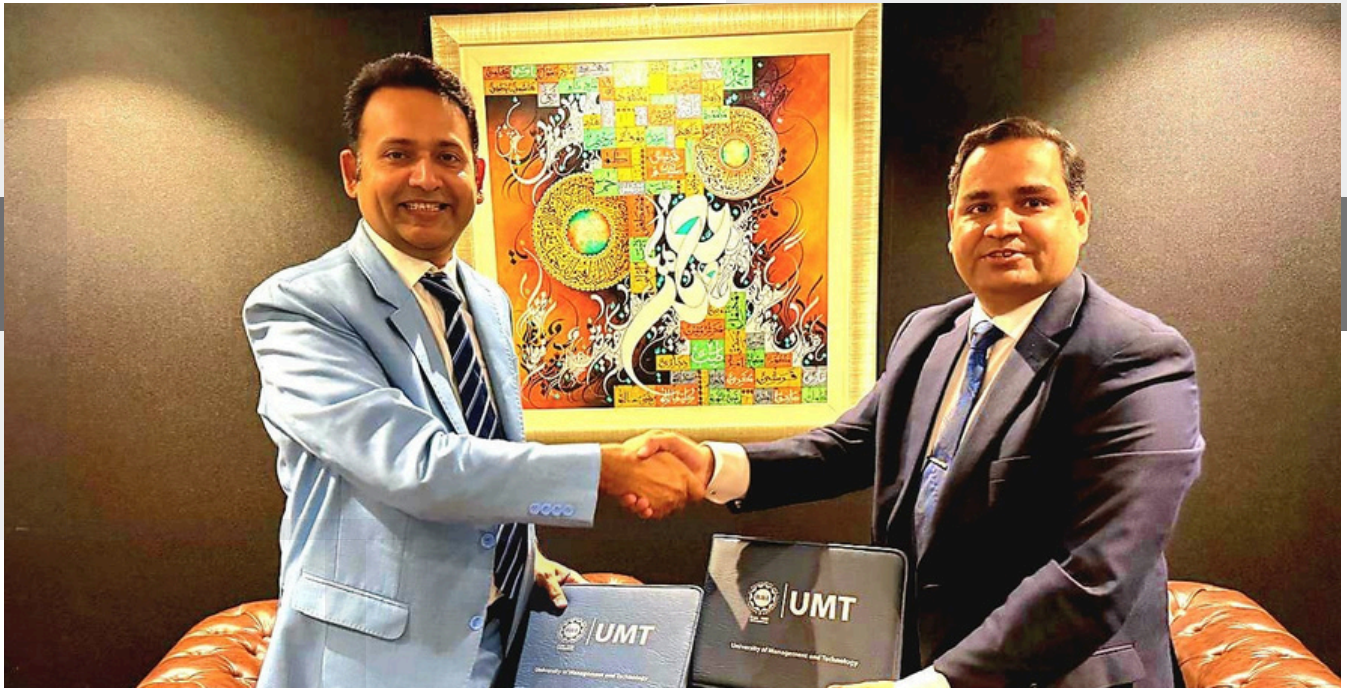
PAK-PACIFIC BRIEF

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ADVANCING INDEPENDENT
DISCOURSE ON ASIA-PACIFIC



CAPS SIGNS MOU WITH DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE & INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS, UNIVERSITY OF MANAGEMENT & TECHNOLOGY, LAHORE

Consortium for Asia Pacific Studies (CAPS) signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Department of Political Science and International Relations at UMT (DPSIR, UMT) to strengthen academic and research collaboration. Both institutions have agreed to jointly organise conferences, seminars, workshops, and scholarly dialogues on issues of mutual interest. The MoU also aims to enhance knowledge exchange, research opportunities, and academic networking between faculty, researchers, and students. This collaboration is expected to foster innovative research, promote critical discourse on contemporary political and security issues, and provide a platform for future joint initiatives at national and international levels.



CAPS VISIT TO SVI

A delegation from CAPS visited the Strategic Vision Institute (SVI), Islamabad, on SVI's invitation. The purpose of the visit was to familiarise the researchers and especially the international interns with Pakistan's policy on core issues like nuclear policy and its evolution. The executive director of SVI, Dr Naeem Salik, delivered a lecture on Pakistan's Nuclear Policy and Strategic Stability in South Asia.

Quadcopters Have Become the Taliban's New Weapon – and Pakistan Is Not Ready

CAPS SENIOR VICE PRESIDENT
DR. MUHAMMAD SHOAB
WRITES FOR SMALL WARS JOURNAL

<https://smallwarsjournal.com/2025/09/03/quadcopters-have-become-the-talibans-new-weapon-and-pakistan-is-not-ready/>



"Pakistan's Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP) province and Balochistan have experienced a serious uptick in militant activities targeting Pakistani state infrastructure and personnel. Terror groups, especially the Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP), are using advanced and sophisticated drone technology. Unlike a few early episodes, they are not using drones only for psychological operations by recording terror attacks. In recent days, they have employed drones to attack Pakistani military assets deployed to secure the area from cross-border terrorism emanating from Afghanistan."



PAK-PACIFIC BRIEF

- The High Commission of Malaysia hosts a Malaysian food festival in Islamabad.
- Pakistan and Japan hold the 14th round of political consultations.
- Pakistan and China agree to establish \$7 billion ML-1 railway financing consortium.
- Vietnam, establishes honorary consulate in Lahore.
- Australia names streets after Pakistani cities.
- Pakistan to issue \$1bn Panda bonds in the Chinese capital market by December.
- Japanese Film Festival 2025 opens in Karachi.
- Japan shows interest in investing in Reko Diq mine.
- Pakistan, Japan hold Economic Policy Dialogue
- President Asif Ali Zardari paid a 10-day visit to China
- 7 Pakistani firms participated in the Fine Food Australia 2025.
- Senate Chairman Yousaf Raza Gilani and Australian High Commissioner Neil Hawkins discuss enhancing cooperation.
- Pakistani scientist in China, Dr. Shaukat Ali awarded Tamgha-e-Imtiaz.
- Pakistan delegation represents country at APPCED moot in Seoul, led by Senator Pervaiz Rashid.



IMEC without Türkiye: Can India succeed without bridge to Europe?

UMAIR PERVEZ KHAN & M. ASIF KHAN
WRITE FOR DAILY SABAH

"IMEC embodies both India's aspirations and its strategic dilemmas. If fully realized, the corridor could reduce India-Europe transport time by 40% and costs by 30%, a potential economic game-changer. But as of now, IMEC remains more a vision than a functioning system: a vision of India standing tall in the emerging order, of trade routes redrawn, and of a new model of transcontinental cooperation."

<https://www.dailysabah.com/opinion/op-ed/imec-without-turkiye-can-india-succeed-without-bridge-to-europe>

The decline of US influence in the Pacific: A blessing for Palestine

CAPS RESEARCHER
SHARJEEL SIDDIQUI
WRITES FOR MIDDLE EAST MONITOR

<https://www.middleeastmonitor.com/20250923-the-decline-of-us-influence-in-the-pacific-a-blessing-for-palestine/>



"The Palestinians and the Pacific Islanders are natural allies. Both peoples have a long struggle of striving for independence and self-determination. Now that the influence of any single power in the region is declining and the PICs are becoming increasingly diplomatically untethered, it provides the Palestinians a unique opportunity. By achieving closer relations with the PICs and highlighting their shared efforts, Palestinians can remove a bulwark for Israel. This would serve to isolate Israel internationally and increase diplomatic pressure."



CAPS IN MEDIA

Dr. Khuram Iqbal, President CAPS, gave an interview to BBC Urdu, in which he outlined the leading factors behind the resurgence of TTP. Moreover, he also talked with SBS Australia about the Pakistan-Saudi Arab Defence Deal, unpacking the seismic shifts in regional security dynamics. He dives into its impact on Saudi-India relations and the potential of this deal to expand to other GCC states.